

AGENTS OF ETERNAL RECURRENCE



Agents of Eternal Recurrence

by Kaleido & Friends

Commentary booklet written by "Kaleido"

"What if some day or night a demon were to steal after you into your loneliest loneliness, and say to you, "This life as you now live it and have lived it, you will have to live once more and innumerable times more; and there will be nothing new in it, but every pain and every joy and every thought and sigh and everything unutterably small or great in your life will have to return to you, all in the same succession and sequence" ... Would you not throw yourself down and gnash your teeth and curse the demon who spoke thus? Or have you once experienced a tremendous moment when you would have answered him: "You are a god and never have I heard anything more divine." "

– *"The Gay Science," Friedrich Nietzsche*

(You're certain that Nietzsche said that.)

Foreword

by "Kaleido"

To talk about Agents of Eternal Recurrence, we need to talk about Rain.

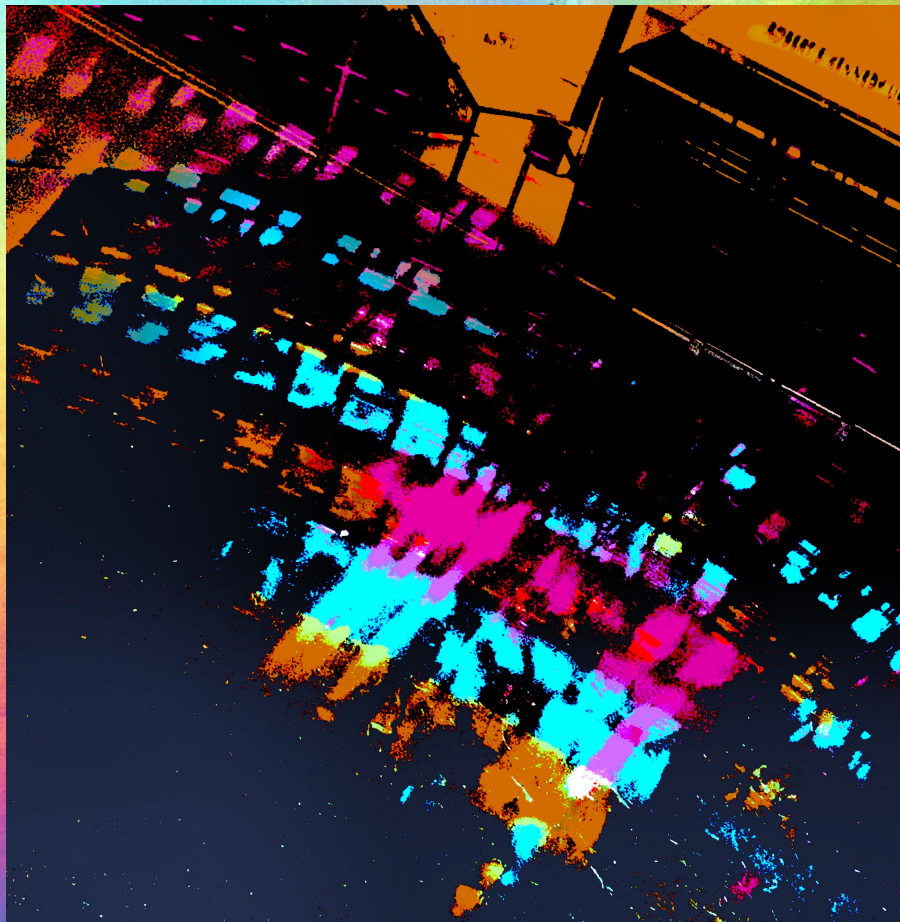
When I was 15-16 years old, I had an idea to make a concept album about the Homestuck fandom. It would be a rock opera of grand proportions, an 88 minutes long undertaking, with musical stylings ranging from synthpop to indie rock to zolo and Bulgarian choir music.

It sucked. But I'm glad that album exists. In a way, Agents of Eternal Recurrence is an album ABOUT that album.

Rain was filled with so much irony, so much pretentiousness and general self-importance; I've always wanted to make an album about Homestuck with none of that shit, because my music, nowadays, is generally known for how heartfelt and unironic it is. Basically, my roots as a musician come from Homestuck - and my current fans don't know that, and the Homestuck fandom doesn't know what my music is like now. This is the bridge that gaps them together, I hope.

This album is also my tribute to Michael Guy Bowman's phenomenal record "Mobius Trip and Hadron Kaleido," and I hope he is proud of me for making this album. I tried to put all the little things about his music that I love into these songs. This is my excuse to make my own "Moons of Theseus," an incredible fan tribute to MTAHK that I wish I had contributed to.

Agents of Eternal Recurrence, originally titled "Agents of Skaia," is an album I've wanted to make for years. My love letter to the Homestuck fandom. My love letter to you. Thanks for listening!



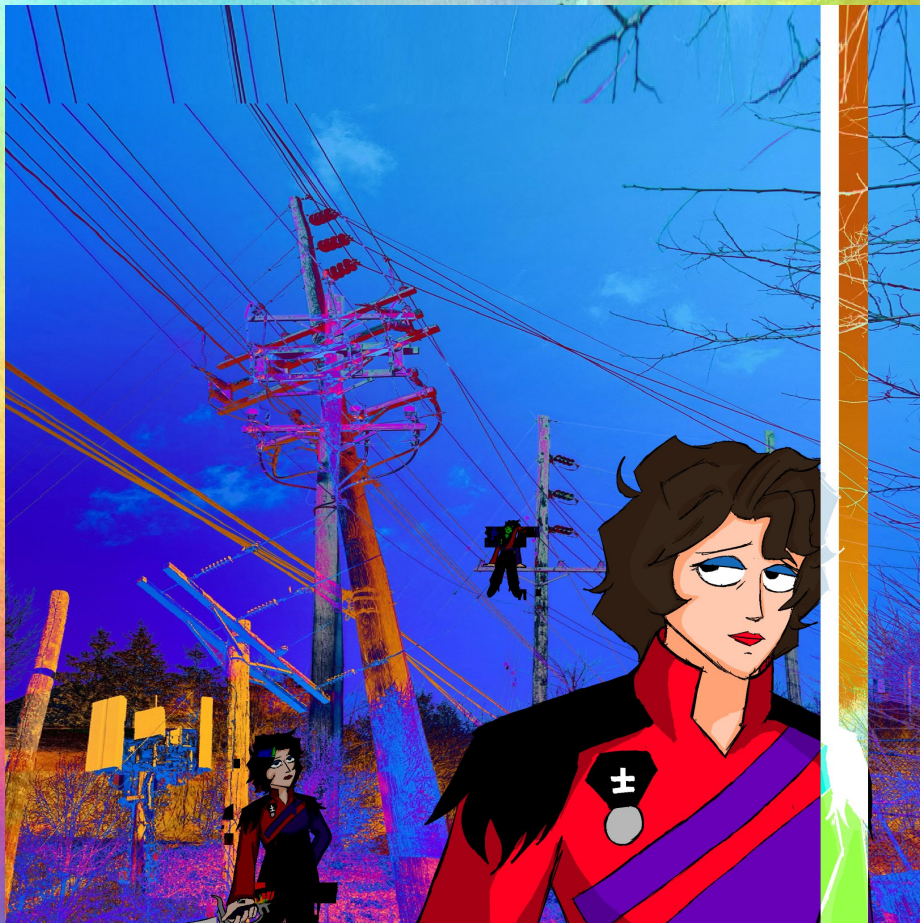
The Riddle

Featuring Tee-vee on electric and bass guitar

Art by Griffin Wayne

Each track in Agents of Eternal Recurrence mirrors a song from Mobius Trip and Hadron Kaleido, following its tracklist song by song. "The Riddle" is my take on "Forever," featuring the phenomenal Tee-vee on electric guitar. A less ambient and more percussive heavy post-rock track.

Since I don't have space in the next commentary, I just wanted to say that my girlfriend Serena did the guitars for the next song, Memories! She was going to record guitars for every track but she had to move and didn't have time.



Memories

by Kaleido

Featuring Serena Warner on electric guitar

Art by pktgrillao & Griffin Wayne

"Dawn of Man" is such a visceral, personal track, and I love that THAT is what MTAHK starts out with. A deeply existential song about mortality and life's purpose in the face of death. It has nothing to do with Homestuck, yet has everything to do with it.

I guess this is my attempt to live up to that opening banger. "Memories" is about my thoughts on my legacy as an artist. As a musician who has made so many songs, so many albums and so many stories, I often wonder what will eventually survive and be remembered in history. And is being remembered what really matters anyway, or is it the present that matters? I wanted to talk about how I feel about those feelings. I didn't wanna rehash the same themes as "Dawn of Man," but wanted to make a song that is equally personal to me as a musician.

Memories lyrics

This is what happens again
Everything happens for a reason
And when you trace back the origins
You'll find that everything's connected
Make a little piece of yourself
Throw it out into the sea
The God of Music, she's a fickle one
You don't know if you'll even matter

It's been a long long time
Since I began this journey
And have I even made a difference in the end?

Useless in the end
And even your friends
Do they really care
And it's only fair
Write a song you won't forget
It's something I'll never regret
I will always keep these memories with me

And it keeps happening
Damn, I warned you about them
If this is how I'll be remembered
Guess I'll die without a worry
Can I leave a legacy?
Before I am forgotten
First it's your name, then it's your soul
A glorious way to survive

It's been a long long time
And yet no time at all
And can you truly say that you did matter in the
end?

Useless in the end
And even your friends
Do they really care
And it's only fair
Write a song you won't forget
It's something I'll never regret
I will always keep these memories with me

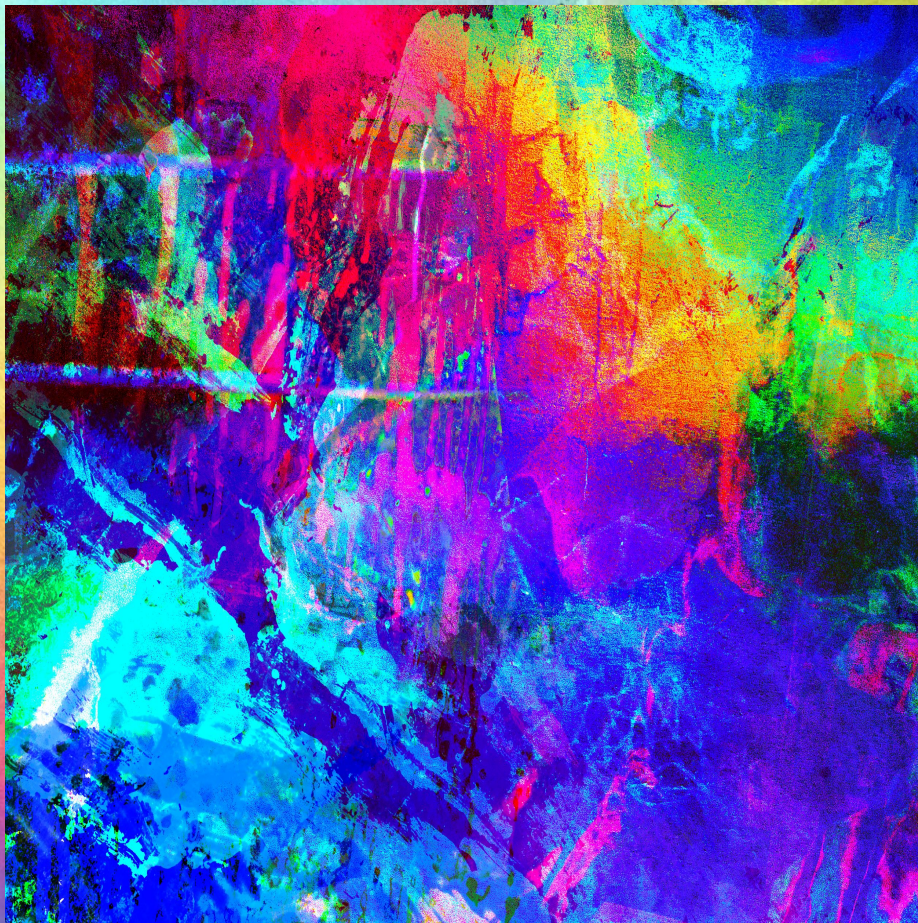


Indev

*Featuring cookiefonster on tracker
Art by Griffin Wayne*

An homage to Anamanaguchi, a band I only found thanks to Toby "Radiation" Fox - whose works also helped me discover Homestuck. See, if you think about it that way, everything's all connected! That's what Memories is also about, btw. It's about my philosophy as an artist, how I believe all artists are pulling from the same "ocean" of inspirations.

Also, Cedric AKA Cookiefonster did the chiptune-y parts in this song. When he heard the draft for this song he said it sounded like "Last Goodbye" from Undertale, which is also an obvious Anamanaguchi homage. Mission accomplished, I'd say!



Troll Romance

Featuring Biddy Fox on vocals
Art by Griffin Wayne

See, my idea for the "No Release" equivalent track was to make a song making fun of the troll quadrants. But I quickly ran into an issue.

1. I love shipping. I'm a shipper. I'm an old, classic type of fandom girly, who likes shipping.

2. I think the quadrants are fun. I know they were made to make fun of shippers. I don't care. I have a moirail in real life. Hussie invented "queerplatonic" before that became a thing people said 10 years later.

So in the end, I had to follow what my heart told me. This is an ode to all the shippers out there, who, in my opinion, really keeps a fandom alive. It is the shippers who still make fan art, fanfics and music even after so much time. The creator of Mobile Suit Gundam attributed the success of the franchise to fujoshis. That tells you everything, I think.

This song is also sung by my friend Biddy Fox, my fellow bandmate in the band MIDI Bunny! She says she sang this song from the perspective of Nepeta so that's canon now.

Troll Romance lyrics

4 million 13 thousand ways
Searching in the field
Through the gaze
We have been waiting here for days
Combing through every line
Every text

Round and round, the chart goes by
Who ends up with who and why
It's exciting
Who will die, who will cry?

Let's go on this path with me
We can look for chemistry
All I want's for you to see what I see
The fun of troll romance

We know there's no point to this
We just draw our fantasies
For our God
There's just one thing I want to say to you
Oh god, it's absurd, but
Will you be moirails with me?

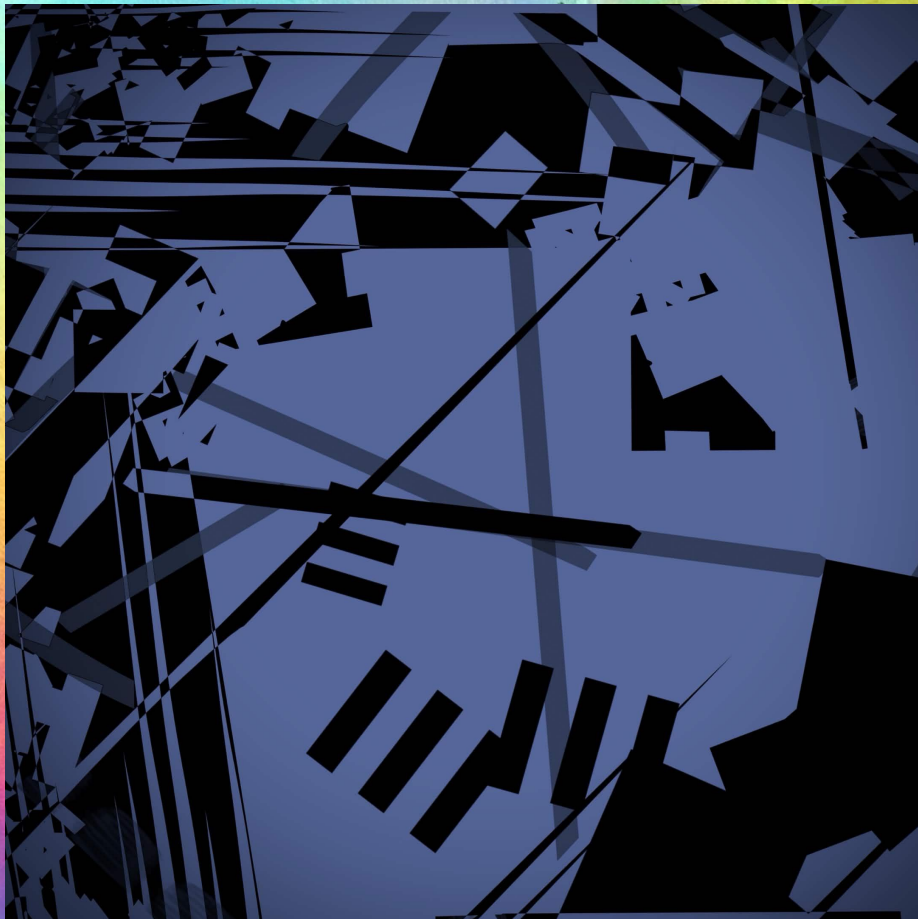
Round and round, the chart goes by
Who ends up with who and why
It's exciting
Who will die, who will cry?

Let's go on this path with me
We can look for chemistry
All I want's for you to see what I see
The fun of troll romance

Diamonds, hearts and spades and clubs
Quadrants, symbols of our love
But there's no way I can tell anyone
We have made it come this far
Can't deny it's who we are
And when it's over and done
We can keep it going still

Round and round, the chart goes by
Who ends up with who and why
It's exciting
Who will die, who will cry?

Let's go on this path with me
We can look for chemistry
All I want's for you to see what I see
The love of troll romance



The Corruption

Featuring Circlejourney on vocals
Art by Griffin Wayne

"Fly" is a song about sweet bro and hella jeff, so for its mirror track, I wanted to write a song about cool and new web comic. The thing we all came here for! (At first.)

I've always wanted to explore the idea of The Corruption: What does it mean to become a "shittier" version of yourself? How would Rose feel in that situation, having lost all of her friends and watching them be transformed into these deranged psychopaths? And, of course, we eventually discover that Rose herself was "corrupted," only having been "enhanced" recently. I think of this song as taking place in her "mental breakdown" [S] page, contemplating all these feelings and revelations.

Taking a stupid memey premise and turning it into a serious thing is basically what CANWC is known for!

I got Circlejourney to perform this song, who did an incredible job. I took inspiration from their works, such as the songs "First Storm of Summer" and "Summer Heat." I love their works and it was a pleasure to work with them here.

The Corruption lyrics

Fade away
Memories gone and dead
So I'll fly, fly
Fly away
Am I insane?
All my friends
Twisted, changed
And I can't, can't
Can't stay

Break it down

Everything I knew, gone
What is left here just taunts
Only scribbles left in MS Paint
I could do it right
Leave all behind
Something I just might do out of time
Draw me to close to sight
Get ready to jump, jump, jump
This stupidity is driving me insane
It's like I am trapped in some kind of a nightmare hell
So take a step back
But I can't relax
Put it back in track
Gotta face the facts, facts, facts

Was the world I'm from even real?
Did the friends I have exist?
Lost in shitty art and JPEG compression
Am I all alone?

Oh, and they just keep happening
Someone warned me long ago
I have to make sense of all of this
So don't give up
Not until they're all back

The Corruption cont.

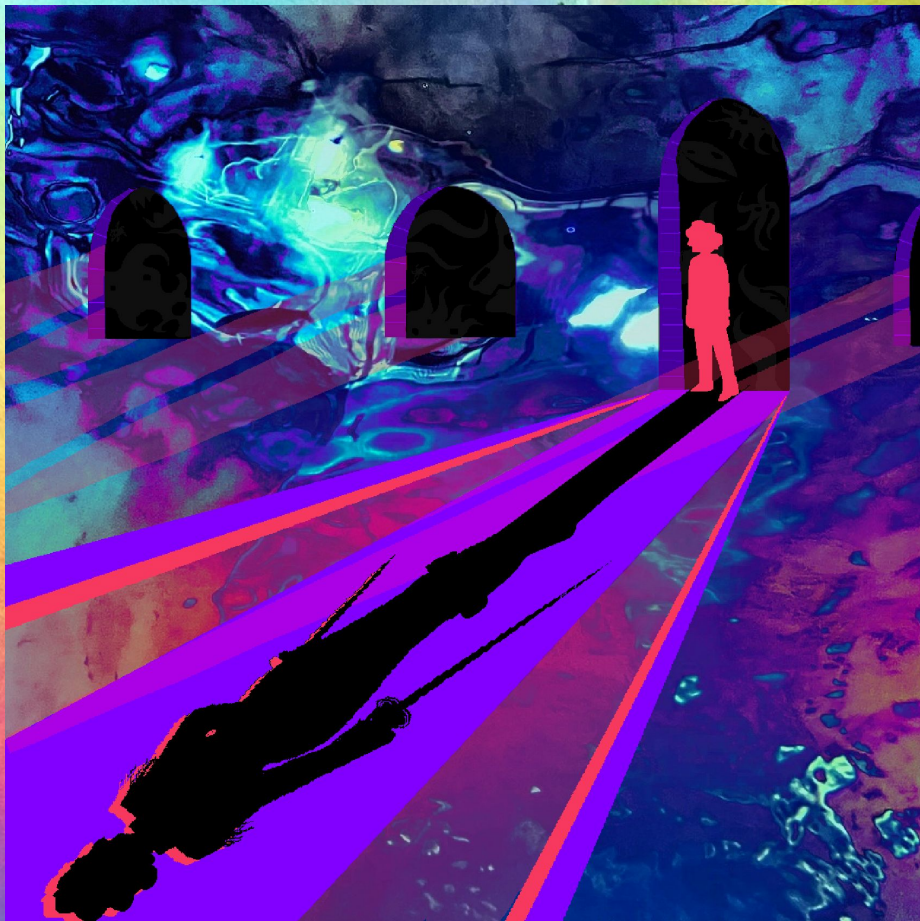
I'm in too deep
(Am I even real)
(Get me out of here)
It may seem
(Can I trust myself?)
That I am alone here
(I sink into insanity)
I'm holding on
(All of you have changed)
(And I'm terrified)
To a hope
(Don't have anyone)
That I'm not just crazy
(Are these memories worth cherishing?)

Was the world I'm from even real?
Did the friends I have exist?
Lost in shitty art and JPEG compression
Am I all alone?

Oh, and they just keep happening
Someone warned me long ago
I have to make sense of all of this
So don't give up
Not until they're all back

Corrupted
It's inside my mind
And twisted
Will it turn out fine?

Corrupted
This is out of line
No choice left
Running out of time



It's Hard (Growing Up)

*Featuring Kal-la-kal-la on vocals and guitar
Art by bunnysoryu & Griffin Wayne*

This is the oldest song in the album, dating all the way back to 2017, although it bares no resemblance whatsoever to that version musically. I had an idea to make a "Lies With the Sea" tribute for Rain, and get Rayhana (AKA Kal-la-kal-la) to sing it, so I finally decided to whip this one out. The only thing I really kept is the iconic lyric, the "It's hard" line, which - and sometimes people are shocked to remember this - is said by Eridan. And hey, Eridan, underwater theme, it all came together in the end!

Rayhana also absolutely rips in this one. Go check out her works as Nasqueron if you're looking for this kind of noisy guitar music!

Anyway, this is a song about Rose and her mom.

It's Hard lyrics

Cold
Cold, cold water
Makes you smother
In cold ice
I'll be your daughter
Will another drink suffice?

So I'm never going back home
I don't understand these petty rules
All I wanna do is hold you tight and don't let go
I might never see you again
Could you at least tell me it's okay?
I don't want this to be the last time I see of you

Somewhere in this strange, new land
I may find another chance
Years will line up, so discard
Growing up, Rose
It's hard

Pain
Painful dodger
Will you mother me from hurt
I'll be your martyr
Will the others just avert?

Yes, I'm never going back home
All those painful memories are there
If you're gonna die, then at least say that you loved
me
When I see myself in the mirror
I see your reflection looking back
Oh my god, have I become what I once despised?

Somewhere in this strange, new land
I may find another chance
Years will line up, so discard
Growing up, Rose
It's hard



Web Comic

*Featuring WHATISLOSTINTHEMINES on vocals
and Michael Guy Bowman on spoken word*

Art by Griffin Wayne

This is probably the stupidest song I've ever written. My idea was, well, "Chain of Prosprit" is basically what people imagine a "Homestuck song with lyrics" would be like, with direct references to the comic itself. How about I take that one step further and just write a song ABOUT making Homestuck fan comics???

Our good friend Tay (AKA WHATISLOSTINTHEMINES) takes the reins here for the lead vocals, something they belted out in a day which is impressive. But also somehow I got Michael Guy Bowman himself to do the "Losing My Edge" LCD Soundsystem parody segment. We're all still trying to figure out how this happened.

There is also an interpolation of "Would You Like to Talk About Homestuck" by Ken Ashcorp here, a very old song that makes fun of Homestuck fans. I found it through the band Ear Piercings' cover of it, which takes its cynicism and turns the song into a genuine celebration of the fandom. If I was going to reference any song in this album, I thought it'd be this one.

Web Comic lyrics

When I was young
I read something
I didn't know what all of it meant
But it touched a string in my heart
And I threw myself into a world of art

Don't care if nobody cares
I just got my trusty tablet with me
So what will the name of this young man be?

I'm torn between two fragile lines-
I can't wait to see what I find

Let's make something that forever lasts
And form a bond that lasts a lifetime
Cool and new, it's everything we do
I'm never going back to that old place

The only reason I'm doing this is because I love you
So let's make a web comic!

I'm losing my edge
But I was there on April 10
I was on the forums and skype
All the newgens tell me
"Don't make fanventures like that"
But I put a photo of my own face in mine
And you're still using it as an emoji!

Problem Sleuth
Ryanquest
Formspring
Dave's blog
Dante Basco
Whistles
And It Don't Stop
Barty Anderson
jandrew edits
The Squiddles OP
Crashing Newgrounds
The caucasians!
The caucasians!
The caucasians!
The caucasians!

Web Comic cont.

I'm torn between two fragile lines-
I can't wait to see what I find

Let's make something that forever lasts
And form a bond that lasts a lifetime
Cool and new, it's everything we do
I'm never going back to that old place

The only reason I'm doing this is because I love you
So let's make a web comic!

Hey there
Would you like to talk about Homestuck?
Please don't run away from me
I'm not that kind of guy, you see
Hey there
Would you like to talk about Homestuck...



Perfectly Generic Object (Appearify)

Featuring Wight's End on vocals

And the Friends on gang vocals

Art by Griffin Wayne

The last song I wrote for the album. Working title was "Appearification." At first, I wanted to write about Problem Sleuth, but I couldn't really remember much, so I started looking at the MSPA Wiki page for appearifiers. Then I remembered Roxy's whole thing with apperifying stuff, and I ended up writing a song about doomed/null timelines, which made it a lot more interesting than if it were just PS references.

The song is obviously inspired by Modify by Lemon Demon (the hooks even rhyme!) but I hope there's a bit of They Might Be Giants energy seeping through here with the usage of the accordion.

We also got an ungodly amount of people to shout "APPEARIFY!!!" for this song. I hope you're happy.

Appearify lyrics

Set the coordinates
Readjust your latitude
Making way for heaven
Figure out the longitude
Gotta set the numbers
Up where in the altitude
But you gotta be sharp
Careful with the line
Don't fuck with the future
And be on time

Spawn as many as you want
Don't worry; they'll be gone
Clean up the mess when you're done
Your life is doomed

Appearify!
Appearify!
Appearify!

Bodies stacked in mountains
You'll see a familiar face
Abscond into the void
You're gonna leave without a trace
Try to outrun it
Outcome is always the same
You can never stop it
It will end in tears
You can't run away
It's already here

Spawn as many as you want
Don't worry; they'll be gone
Clean up the mess when you're done
Your life is doomed

Appearify!
Appearify!
Appearify!

Appearify cont.

When you're a corpse
It doesn't matter what you said it was
The fact is
You never mattered at all
So sink into irrelevance
You'll realise your own helplessness
And I'll take you down to the bottom with me...

Spawn as many as you want
Don't worry; they'll all be gone
Clean up the mess when you're done
Your life is doomed

Appearify!
Appearify!
Appearify!
Appearify!
Appearify!
Appearify!



Down the Rabbit Hole

Featuring Ucklin on vocals and lyrics
Art by bunnysoryu & Griffin Wayne

The final track is a collaboration with Ucklin, who I'm proud to call a good, longtime friend of mine. She wrote the verses and the chorus, (based on my concepts) and gave me some notes on the rest of the lyrics as well, so this is the only song that is actually co-written.

I wanted to cap off the album with a genuine, earnest song about venturing into a fandom, likening it to the "rabbit hole" from Alice in Wonderland, and the feeling of going deeper and deeper inside this iceberg.

Musically, if you haven't noticed, it is a pastiche of "The Machine" by Lemon Demon. I wanted this album to have a "Geek Rock" vibe to it, so there's a lot of Lemon Demon, They Might Be Giants and, of course, Bowman influences on it.

Down the Rabbit Hole lyrics

you look afraid
maybe you envy me

and if I had seen all that you have seen
and if I had been all that you have been

I think I'd be scared too

your eyes are wild and searching for a place to hide
you think you need to bolt away and never look behind you
like you think that I do
but I am wild and searching for the underside
the lurking things found only here
that I could share with you

the world is more than
something to hide from
this place is more than a hideaway
and when you're ready
come down here with me
I'll show you how far the rab-bit hole goes

I'll show you how far the rabbit hole goes
How deep it goes
Down, down
I'll show you how far the rabbit hole goes
How deep it goes
Down, down

Join me and play
In a land of fantasy

You can dive in head first between the blades
You can kick all the dirt and shame away

It's yours for the choosing

You can't believe that someone else would care to share your
lifeblood

But down here, the eager roots and teeth are clamoring to
chatter 'bout it
And, so, my dear, I'll leave it up to you to choose how you will
live

Just don't forget where you first came in from

the world is more than
something to hide from
this place is more than a hideaway
and when you're ready
come down here with me
I'll show you how far the rab-bit hole goes

(Down, down far below, somewhere safe)
(Lost in the wave once again)

Down the Rabbit Hole cont.

Now it's been a decade
and the friends I had are no more
and the rabbit never shows herself
And no one recognizes me
The things I love are tainted
With the crazy things that happen in life
I don't know if I can keep on going like I used to now

But one day she comes back to me
repeats what she once said-
"You can lose faith in art
But don't forget where it comes from
the things we love can be so hard to justify
But do remember what defines you isn't art but memories you
made while you were looking at it"

Just because the rabbit hole is something that will outlive you
It doesn't mean you have to be ashamed of what it has
become
So from finale to genesis, we give the world back its art
And we exit the rabbit hole, prideful in our hearts



Music and lyrics by Kaleido (NOT Cecily Renns)

Featuring the musical talents of:

Tee-vee on "The Riddle" (electric guitar, bass guitar)

Serena Warner on "Memories" (electric guitar)

Cookiefonster on "Indev" (co-composition, tracker)

Biddy Fox on "Troll Romance" (vocals)

Circlejourney on "The Corruption" (vocals)

Kal-la-kal-la on "It's Hard (Growing Up)" (vocals, electric guitar)

WHATISLOSTINTHEMINES on "Web Comic" (vocals)

Michael Guy Bowman on "Web Comic" (spoken word)

Wight's End on "Perfectly Generic Object (Appearify)"
(vocals)

Ucklin on "Down the Rabbit Hole" (lyrics and vocals)

"Appearify" gang vocals by: Memon, Socks, Lamby,
Harper, Tay, salex_r3kt, Elise, Skye, Ucklin, Tee-vee,
NeRd, Memo, Cello

Album art by Griffin Wayne
Track art backgrounds by Griffin Wayne

Track 2 art by pktgrillao
Track 6 & 9 art by bunnysoryu

AGENTS OF ETERNAL RECURRENCE



Thanks for listening!